

BLINK LIGHT

YOUR DESK, IN COLOUR

WHAT EACH COLOUR MEANS
the shipped defaults

ON A SCHEDULE fires whether or not the watcher is running

WHEN	WHAT THE LIGHT DOES	COLOUR	LENGTH
08:13 daily	Standup in 2 minutes. Three flashes.	 #FFD700 gold	0.96s
08:15 daily	Standup now. Six faster flashes.	 #FFD700 gold	1.44s
:00 every hour	One white breath. Another hour has gone.	 #FFFFFF white	0.80s
17:00 daily	Rainbow swirl across both LEDs. End of the working day.	 from #730000 28 hues	9.92s
17:15 daily	The rainbow again, for the evenings you worked through the first one.	 from #730000 28 hues	9.92s

WHEN SOMETHING HAPPENS one-shots played over whatever is showing

WHEN	WHAT THE LIGHT DOES	COLOUR	LENGTH
AI agent finishes	One slow breath. Come back and review it.	 #4FC3F7 Herdr blue, full	0.90s
...and more are waiting	One slow climb out of the dark. The burst cap is showing.	 #14313E to #4FC3F7 Herdr blue, climbing	1.12s
AI agent blocked	Three quicker breaths. It needs an answer from you.	 #801E00 dim red	1.26s
GitHub Actions run fails	Two pairs of heartbeat thumps, with a rest between.	 #803C00 dim orange-red	2.40s
PR review requested	A pulse handed from the top LED to the bottom, twice.	 #442C72 dim violet	2.24s
@mentioned on a PR	A slow swell with a flicker at its peak, twice.	 #442C72 dim violet	2.56s
Your PR was reviewed	A two-step climb, twice.	 #1B112E dimmer violet	1.98s
New request in a queue	A rainbow sweep across both LEDs.	 from #730000 12 hues	2.46s

SET IT YOURSELF blink-light.bat preset <name>

					
available #00C853 free, the default	busy #D50000 in a meeting	calendar_free #8E24AA a Free block	away #2962FF stepped away	focus #FFB300 heads-down	break #00ACC1 on a break

Timer routines paint these same presets: pomodoro is focus then break. Every routine ends on timer_done - white and green, until cleared.

QUIET HOURS

17:00 to 07:00 the light is off and the chime and alarms stay silent.
Both rainbows opt out: they are the end-of-day marker, not something the end of day silences.
Standup sits outside the window, so it is unaffected.

THE RESTING COLOUR watcher only - run watch start

SITUATION	WHAT THE LIGHT DOES	COLOUR	LENGTH
Nothing scheduled	Steady. The light is just on.	 #00C853 green	held
Meeting in 10 minutes	Two slow blinks. Time to wrap up.	 #00E5FF cyan	0.80s
Meeting in 5 minutes	Four quick blinks.	 #FF00C8 magenta	0.96s
In a Busy or Tentative meeting	Steady. Visible to anyone walking up.	 #D50000 red	held
Idle 10+ minutes	Steady. You stepped away.	 #2962FF blue	held

WHICH MEETINGS COUNT

Only Tentative and Busy move the light. Free, Out of Office and Working Elsewhere are ignored entirely - no colour, no warning. All-day events are ignored too.

TELLING THEM APART one LED, a dozen meanings

BAND	MEANS	WHICH EFFECTS
  Cyan, then magenta	A meeting is coming	10 minutes out, then 5
 Red, steady	You are in the meeting	Busy or Tentative
   Gold, orange, dim red	Something wants you	Standup, failed CI, blocked agent
  Dim violet	Pull requests	Review asked, @mention, review in
   Green, blue	Your own state	Free, idle, agent finished
 White	The hour	The chime, on its own

WHY CYAN AND MAGENTA

The meeting warnings were yellow and orange until five different flashes ended up in that warm band at once. Cyan and magenta are used by nothing else. Keep them out of that band if you recolour.

PREVIEW ANY OF IT `blink-light.bat <command>`

alarm test standup_warning	the 2-minute standup warning
chime test	the hourly white breath
show test	the end-of-day rainbow
notify run agent_done	an AI agent finishing
notify run agent_blocked	an AI agent stuck
notify run pr_mentioned	an @mention on a pull request

IF NOTHING IS FLASHING

devices - is the light seen at all? It hangs off the dock, so undocking unplugs it.
status - what the light would do right now, and the reason when it would do nothing.
watch status - the calendar colours above need the watcher running; the scheduler restarts a dead one.
Quiet hours silence everything that has not opted out. Both rainbows have.

Your own `blink-light.json` overrides any of this. Change a default, then rerun `tools/build_reference_card.py`.